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MY POWAI

Volume No. 14 Issue No. 02 Mumbai October 2025

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Dear friends

October arrives wrapped in festive cheer, with the twin celebrations of Dussehra and Diwali lighting up our lives. Here's wishing you and your families joy, togetherness and the strength to overcome all odds

This issue captures the vibrancy of our community with a special coverage of the Ganesh Utsav celebrations across Powai and Chandivali—events filled with devotion, zeal, and unforgettable memories. On our recipe page, Sherry Bhatnagar continues her delightful journey through Odisha, bringing you unique dishes that promise to surprise your taste buds.

As festivals often bring indulgence, our nutritionist helps you with practical tips on how to bounce back to healthy routines after the festive feasts. For those who follow the stars, our astrology section is packed with predictions you shouldn't miss. On a serious note, we carry an eye-opening piece by Chaarvi on the growing menace of drugs in Powai. Parents, please stay vigilant—sometimes awareness and timely action can make all the difference.

If you notice something amiss, do not hesitate to raise your voice. Stay connected with us on Instagram and X for daily updates and community highlights.

Wishing you a safe, joyous, and sparkling October!.

Warm regards,
Mahesh Kutty
(Editor)

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If you see or experience any act of injustice in our locality please report to us: mypowai@yahoo.in

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Redevelopment bug hits Powai



D.P.K. Udas

Powai, the eastern suburb of Mumbai, developed relatively late. Due to its distance from railway lines and commuting challenges, people initially preferred settling elsewhere. Most of the buildings here aren't very old—the construction began about 25 years ago and picked up pace in the last two decades.

Mumbai, however, has many old buildings with tenants who had moved in under the 'pugree' system. With rents frozen, landlords were unable to maintain these structures, leaving many of them in a dilapidated state. Every monsoon, news of collapsing buildings causing casualties would surface.

To address this, the government introduced a redevelopment policy by granting additional FSI. Builders could sell extra flats to fund reconstruction. This solved the issue to some extent, and many buildings in South and Central Mumbai were redeveloped.

As property prices in Mumbai soared nearly tenfold, redevelopment projects became highly lucrative. The "bug" of redevelopment spread to the western suburbs up to Dahisar and the eastern suburbs up to Mulund. Even Thane began witnessing such projects, with "cluster development" being allowed there.

Another factor is the near-complete absence of vacant plots in Mumbai. This has pushed builders to aggressively hunt for redevelopment opportunities. They are luring societies with promises of modern amenities in exchange for redevelopment rights.



While redeveloping 60-year-old buildings makes sense, the lure of high profits has led to even 25-year-old buildings being demolished. For instance, the City Park building in Powai is set to go under the hammer. The current 4-storey structure will be replaced by a 22-storey tower. Several older structures opposite IIT, like Shradhamata, are also being razed for reconstruction. Even the building housing Powai's iconic "Haico" store will face demolition.

From a city planner's perspective, this rapid redevelopment poses serious challenges. Water supply and drainage systems will come under strain. If housing stock increases five to six times, how will the infrastructure cope? Each new flat will likely bring at least two cars, further burdening Powai's already congested roads.

Residents face immediate concerns during redevelopment:
1. Dust pollution from demolition.
2. Roads damaged by debris-carrying dumpers.
3. Traffic from incoming construction material and concrete mixers.
4. Noise from piling and foundation work.
5. Sleepless nights due to round-the-clock construction.

Yet, redevelopment has its advantages:
1. Wider roads and footpaths around new projects.
2. Modern column-and-beam construction replacing brick-and-mortar.
3. Stronger earthquake resistance (a fault line passes through Powai).
4. Employment opportunities for construction workers and material suppliers.
5. Options for Powai residents seeking bigger or newer flats within the area.
6. Added amenities like gardens, swimming pools, and air-conditioned lobbies.
7. Improved stormwater drainage to reduce urban flooding.

In the end, Powai is caught in the whirlwind of change—progress with its share of pain.

"Ae dil hai mushkil jeena yahan, zara hanske, zara bachke, yeh Powai meri jaan."

(The author is long time resident of Powai. He takes up civic issues with the authorities. He has been instrumental in improving illumination in the area, zebra crossings , garbage removal etc.)



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Honouring the legacy, inspiring the future – HFSI Founder's Day 2025



The Founder's Day celebration at Hiranandani Foundation School International on 17th September 2025 was a day filled with tradition, gratitude, and inspiration. The atmosphere in the school was alive with excitement as students, teachers, and staff came together to welcome the trustee whose vision and guidance have shaped the institution over the years.

The day began with a warm and traditional welcome as Dr. Niranjan Hiranandani arrived at the school lobby. He was greeted with a stroke of blessing ritual, a gesture steeped in cultural significance that set the tone for the day. As he proceeded upstairs, he was handed a unique reading passport, a creative initiative designed to track how many books students have read. This thoughtful gesture beautifully reflected the school's commitment to fostering a love for reading and lifelong learning among its students.

The ceremony commenced with the lighting of the lamp in honour of the late Dr. L. H. Hiranandani, whose dedication to education and service continues to inspire generations. The glow of the lamp symbolized wisdom and knowledge, illuminating not only the stage but also the hearts of everyone present.

Adding a personal touch to the occasion, the IBDP Year 1 students had prepared a welcome video as a tribute to Dr. L. H. Hiranandani. The video served as a heartfelt acknowledgment of the values and vision he stood for, reminding everyone of the legacy on which the school stands. Following this moving tribute, Dr. Niranjan Hiranandani was formally welcomed, felicitated, and presented with a gift as a token of appreciation for his invaluable contributions to education and the growth of the institution.

The cultural highlight of the day came when two talented IBDP Year 2 students performed the soulful song "Aashayein." Their melodious voices filled the auditorium with hope and positivity, leaving a lasting impression on the audience and moving the guest of honour with their heartfelt performance.

The principal, Mrs. Kalyani Patnaik, then delivered a warm and heartfelt speech, expressing deep gratitude towards Dr. Niranjan Hiranandani and the founding family. She spoke about the trust, support, and vision that have allowed the school to flourish over the years, acknowledging the pivotal role played by the Hiranandani family in shaping its journey.

In his address to the gathering, Dr. Niranjan Hiranandani shared his thoughts on "How to be Successful," offering valuable insights to the students. He emphasized the importance of the 1% rule—the idea of improving just one percent every day—and the power of continuous learning, urging everyone never to stop gaining knowledge, no matter where life takes them. His words left the audience inspired, providing a simple yet profound roadmap for success.

The event concluded with the entire school joining together to sing the school song, marking the end of a ceremony that was not only a celebration of tradition and gratitude but also a source of inspiration for the entire school community. The day will be remembered as one where culture, wisdom, and learning came together, leaving everyone enriched and motivated to carry forward the legacy of excellence.



Evergreen karaoke singing group organises bollywood songs written by Sahir Ludhianvi



Once again, the Evergreen Karaoke Singing Group presented a unique themed program—this time celebrating the timeless Bollywood songs penned by Sahir Ludhianvi. Aptly titled "Tum Mujhe Yun Bhula Na Paoge", the evening showcased the brilliance of one of India's greatest lyricists, known for capturing every shade of human emotion.

Singers in the age group of 40 to 80 years performed a delightful selection of solos and duets, filling the restaurant hall at Lake Homes, Powai, with melody. Supported by a high-class sound system, the audience was treated to evergreen numbers such as Aji Rooth Kar Kahan Jaiyega, Main Kamsin Hun Nadan Hun, Jaane Kahan Gaye Woh Din, Woh Chand Khila Woh Taare Haseen, Sama Hai Suhana Suhana, Unse Mili Nazar, Tumne Kisi Ki Jaan Ko Jaate Hue Dekha Hai, Tumsa Nahin Dekha, Zindagi Ka Safar, Tum Ruthi Raho Main Manata Rahun, Sayonara Sayonara, Isharon Isharon Mein, Ehsaan Tera Hoga Mujh Par, Mujhe Raat Din Ye Khayal Hai, Gumnaam Hai Koi, Dil Ke Jharokhe Se, Teri Zulfon Se Judaai, Raat Ka Sama Jhoome Chandrama, Akele Akele Kahan Ja Rahe Ho, Sun Sahiba Sun, Pyar Ki Dhun, Kaun Hai Jo Sapnon Mein Aaya, and Tum Kitni Khubsurat Ho, among others.

The evening began with members being welcomed with refreshing drinks and sumptuous snacks, followed by tea. After the melodious program, a delicious dinner was served. The celebrations didn't stop there—birthdays of members and their family members were also marked with a cake, chocolates, and gifts, adding to the festive spirit.

The Evergreen Karaoke Singing Group organises themed musical evenings once every month.

To join, contact organiser Bhupendra Shah at 9324662290.

- Preeti Oka

Navratri traditions continue at Raheja Vihar



For years, the senior women of Raheja Vihar have nurtured a heartwarming tradition during Navratri — one that beautifully blends devotion, colour and companionship.

Each day of the nine-day festival, they drape themselves in sarees reflecting the colour of the day, a vibrant expression of faith and festivity.

Together, they visit one home each day, filling it with the sacred energy of Goddess Durga's shlokas. The rhythmic chanting creates an atmosphere of peace and positivity, leaving behind a divine presence that lingers long after the women have called it a day. For the host, it is a day of great joy, welcoming not just guests but dear friends. These gatherings are more than rituals — they are blessings that enrich both hearts and households.

What makes this practice truly special is the bond it fosters among neighbours. Over the years, this daily journey has turned acquaintances into friends and friends into family, strengthening the spirit of togetherness that Raheja Vihar is known for.

In a world that often rushes forward, these women remind us that traditions need not be grand to be meaningful. With devotion in their hearts and unity in their steps, they keep the essence of Navratri alive — one home, one prayer, one day at a time.

REITs – The new way to experience real estate

When I think of real estate, I am reminded of my uncle in Chennai. For him, owning property was the ultimate dream. Over the years, he built a small portfolio—an apartment given out on rent, and a plot that he hoped would appreciate. The rental income gave him pride, but the responsibilities weighed him down. Chasing tenants for timely rent, repairing leaking pipes, paying property tax, and worrying about who would inherit what—it was not as peaceful as he had imagined.

This is the reality for many Indian families. We invest in property for rental income, capital appreciation, and a sense of security. But along with pride comes responsibility. And not everyone can afford to venture into commercial spaces where ticket sizes are in crores.

That's where Real Estate Investment Trusts (REITs) step in. Think of a REIT as a simple bridge between your love for real estate and the convenience of a mutual fund. A REIT pools together commercial real estate—office spaces, business parks, and income-generating properties—so investors like us can own a share, without worrying about maintenance or tenant calls.

Globally trusted and regulated in India by SEBI's REIT Regulations, 2014, REITs bring transparency and discipline. Rules ensure:



80% of assets must be completed, income-generating properties.

Debt cannot exceed 49% of asset value.

At least 90% of distributable cash flows are paid out regularly to investors.
For example, Mindspace Business Parks REIT is listed on NSE and BSE, distributing income quarterly. Investors can benefit from dividends, interest, and repayment of debt, with taxation depending on the nature of payout.

But beyond the numbers lies the real magic—peace of mind. With REITs, you get regular income, liquidity, diversification, and participation in India's commercial growth story, without the hassles of physical ownership.

My uncle, now retired, recently invested in a REIT. For him, it was like owning a slice of India's thriving office parks, minus the burdens. "This feels like real estate," he said, "but lighter on my shoulders."

Sometimes, the smartest investments aren't just about wealth—they're about freeing ourselves to live with dignity, security, and ease.

- Uma Kumaravelan
Certified Financial Planner
www.oaktree.in



Ganapati celebration



Remani's, Kanakia Silicon Valley



Bandekar's, Nahar



Bldg No 22,23 - MHADA



Bldg No 24 - MHADA

Ganapati celebration



Sonagra's, Nahar Amrit Shakti



Sharma's, Kanakia Silicon Valley



Castlerock, Hiranandani Gardens



Synchronicity

Ganapati celebration



Singi's, Kanakia Silicon Valley



Singh's, Kanakia Silicon Valley



Patwardhan's, Hiranandani Gardens



Rustagi's, Hiranandani Gardens

Ganapati celebration



Oza's Kanakia Silicon Valley



Pandey's Kanakia Silicon Valley



Nair's, Raheja Vihar

Ganapati celebration



Krishnan's Nahar Amrit Shakti



Jain's Nahar Amrit Shakti



Kanakia Silicon Valley

Ganapati celebration



Solanki's Kanakia Silicon Valley



Magnolia Utsav, Nahar



Hiranandani cha Maharaj

KSV Ganpati Utsav 2025



Kanakia Silicon Valley (KSV) once again showcased the power of community spirit and devotion through the grand celebration of KSV Ganpati Utsav 2025. Now in its third edition, the festival stood as a testament to the unity and passion of the residents, transforming a simple occasion into a vibrant celebration of faith, joy, and togetherness. The collective effort demonstrated that when hearts unite, even the humblest of events can become sacred.

The beautifully decorated pandal, inspired by the iconic Shrimant Dagdusheth Ganpati Temple, became the centerpiece of the festivities — a serene space where residents gathered in prayer and reverence. Every prayer offered seemed to radiate a divine energy, creating an atmosphere of peace and spirituality.

Key Highlights of the Festival:

Lezim Dance: The festival came alive with the energetic Lezim dance performed by the women of KSV, during both the welcome and visarjan processions. The rhythmic beats and graceful movements infused the air with vibrant energy, setting a joyful tone for the celebrations.

Children's Cultural Engagement: Young residents actively participated in traditional activities such as storytelling, quiz competitions, and idol-making workshops. Their involvement not only deepened their connection to the rich cultural heritage but also fostered a profound respect for tradition.

Tan-Man-Dhan Contributions: Residents selflessly contributed their efforts, time, and resources—Tan (body), Man (mind), and Dhan (wealth)—demonstrating that the true spirit of the festival lies in giving and community service.

Akhand Jyoti: The sacred flame of the Akhand Jyoti burned continuously throughout the festival, tended by devotees in shifts. Evening aartis, accompanied by Prasad and Bhog Thalis, filled the air with a divine fragrance, elevating the spiritual ambiance.

Cultural Performances: Hidden talents from the KSV community took center stage through soulful bhajans and devotional songs, amplifying the spiritual experience. Professional kirtankars and singers added further grace, while a special mention goes to Meher Giridhar for her flawless and captivating Bharatnatyam performance.



Mahabhog on 30th August: The festival culminated in a grand Mahabhog, where nearly 1,000 devotees gathered to share a sacred meal. This act of communal dining reinforced the strong sense of unity, gratitude, and joy among all present.

Ashtavinayak Skit: A remarkable



highlight of this year's celebration was the Ashtavinayak Skit, organized by 10 enthusiastic residents and performed by 40 talented KSV Star Kids. The skit took the audience on a spiritual journey across the eight revered temples of Lord Ganesha. Through lively performances, the children not only entertained but also educated the community about the significance of these sacred sites, blending devotion, culture, and learning seamlessly.

The success of KSV Ganpati Utsav 2025 was made possible by the generous support of KSV residents, Kanakia Group, Ravi Mohan, Shubham Jewellers, Dr. Satyabhama, and Vishal Gawand. Special appreciation goes to the volunteers, contributors, and devotees who played an instrumental role in making the festival more than just an event—transforming it into a spiritual journey.

As Ganapati Bappa bids farewell, the community is filled with gratitude, peace, and joy, eagerly awaiting next year's celebrations to welcome their beloved Bappa once again with the same devotion and happiness.

Ganapati Bappa Morya!



Community comes alive at Lilium Lantana's first Ganesh utsav



In every community's journey, there comes a moment that marks a new beginning – a moment that binds people in spirit, in celebration, and in collective joy. For Lilium and Lantana, that moment arrived this year with the very first Ganesh Utsav.

We witnessed magic across five unforgettable days. We witnessed a miracle that only devotion, unity, and love can create. For the very first time in the history of Lilium and Lantana, our community came together to welcome Lord Ganesha – Vighnaharta, the remover of obstacles. In those days, we not only worshipped Bappa but also discovered the true meaning of togetherness, belonging, and divine grace.

For years, Ganesh Utsav had been celebrated in individual homes at Lilium and Lantana. Every family performed their rituals, every home was filled with devotion, but never before had the society as a whole come together to host Bappa under one roof. This year, with just 15 days of preparation, an idea that began as a simple one-and-a-half-day gathering in the Lilium lobby blossomed into something magnificent – a full-fledged five-day celebration in a beautifully decorated pandal.

From the very beginning, it felt as if Bappa himself guided every step. Challenges arose, but Vighnaharta stood with us. When doubts came, He removed them. When obstacles appeared, they dissolved as though by His grace. What started with hesitation transformed into confidence, and what began as a few helping hands multiplied into many.

The celebrations opened with intense aartis and heartfelt pujas, each moment soaked in devotion. The Satyanarayan puja filled the atmosphere with serenity, while the Diya puja lit up not just the pandal but our hearts. Every prayer, every offering, every chant felt as if Bappa was right there, blessing us with His presence.

Yet this Utsav was not only about rituals – it was about people. It was about our children, some as young as nine months old, who bravely walked onto the stage in their costumes during the fancy-dress show. Their innocence and courage brought laughter, pride, and tears of joy. It was about our residents who sang, danced, and performed with all their hearts, reminding us that celebrations are truly alive when the community itself becomes both the performer and the audience. On Day 3, when the music event by a popular group filled the air, everyone cheered, clapped, and celebrated with an energy that nothing could dampen.

The spirit of contribution was overwhelming. When we asked for five volunteers, we received ten — the very best, who gave their time and energy without hesitation. Residents came forward to sponsor tents, photography, prasad, souvenirs, and gifts. Many dedicated their time to cooking, arranging, and serving prasad and bhog. Others devoted themselves to rehearsals and performances, adding joy to our evenings. The office staff, from housekeeping to security, worked tirelessly, ensuring that everything ran smoothly. Truly, this was not an event organized by a few – it was a Utsav created by all.

And then came the moments of grandeur – the Dhol Tasha troupe in their best form, filling the air with rhythmic beats that stirred our souls. The fireworks lit up the sky, reflecting the joy in our hearts. During the visarjan procession of our eco-friendly idol, we danced together with abandon, united in devotion and love. The phetas adorning many heads added a traditional charm, turning the procession into a memory we will cherish forever.

Behind this seamless celebration stood the unwavering support of the Managing Committee, our sponsors, and our partners, who believed in the dream and gave it their strength. To each of them, and to every resident who offered their time, energy, and prayers – we bow in gratitude.

This Utsav was more than an event. It was a reminder of what happens when a community comes together with one heart. The pandal became not just a space of worship but a space of unity, joy, and discovery. We discovered that we are stronger together, that faith multiplies when shared, and that Bappa's presence is most deeply felt when we stand shoulder to shoulder as one family.

As the first Ganesh Utsav at Lilium Lantana came to a close, with the largest gathering our society has ever seen, we felt Bappa's blessings in every smile, every song, every step of dance, and every aarti. His message was clear – keep this closeness alive, keep this togetherness strong. This bond is precious, and it is what will carry us forward as a community.

With folded hands, we say: Bappa, thank you for choosing to come to us. Thank you for your love and guidance. Keep your blessings on us forever.

Ganpati Bappa Morya! Pudhchya Varshi Lavkar Ya!



Ctrl + Alt + Del My Morning, and My Patience

A parenting meltdown featuring coffee, chaos, and cortisol.



Debika Chaudhuri

It's 8:45 AM. You've got a Zoom call at 9:00. You're half-dressed for work, mentally juggling the day's meetings, and trying to scarf down a quick breakfast.

Your child calls out from across the table, distracting you for just a second.

You reach for your coffee, half focused, but your hand knocks the mug instead of grabbing it.

Hot coffee spills on the table and some goes on to your laptop.
The presentation you worked on last night? Gone.
The device? Not responding.
Your morning? Ruined.
You freeze. For a moment, you want to scream, cry, maybe both. You feel your chest tighten with frustration, helplessness, and disbelief.
You look at your child and before you can stop yourself, you **snap:**

"What did you just do? Can't you sit still for one minute? Look what's happened now! This is completely ruined because of you!"
The words are sharp. Loud. Maybe too loud.
Your child shrinks back, confused, maybe even scared.
You didn't mean to explode like that but in that moment, it felt justified.
Now pause.
Because this is exactly what happens when they are the ones overwhelmed when they can't find their favorite toy, or when the blue plate is in the sink, or when their cereal doesn't look right.
The difference?
You have the vocabulary, the context, and the emotional maturity (most of the time) to know what's really going on.
They don't.

What looks like defiance or drama is often just a tiny nervous system in distress sounding the alarm in the only way it knows how. Their brains are flooded with stress. That's why empathy more than logic, is what they need most in that moment.

What actually makes a difference?
Neuroscience shows that when we respond to our kids' big emotions with empathy and calm, we're not just comforting them, we're actually helping shape their brains to handle emotions better in the future.
Saying something like "I can see you're upset. It's okay to feel sad. I'm here with you," builds emotional resilience.
It's not spoiling, it's supporting.

And no, you don't have to be perfect.
Before you start replaying every moment you lost your cool, take a breath.
You're human. You're juggling real-life chaos: school runs, meetings, traffic, dinner, and endless to-dos. No one is calm 24/7.
You don't need to be a Zen master, you just need to keep showing up.



Here are 3 steps to start you off:
1. Name it to tame it
When your child is overwhelmed by big emotions, help them put those feelings into words. Simply naming what they're feeling can calm the emotional part of their brain and activate the thinking part.
Instead of saying, *"Stop crying, it's just a toy," try something like, "You're upset because your toy broke, that's really frustrating, isn't it?"*
Studies show that kids who learn to identify and express their emotions build stronger self-regulation skills and develop healthier coping mechanisms over time.

2. S-T-O-P
When you notice the emotional storm brewing:
• Stay calm (your regulation helps theirs)
• Tune in to what they're experiencing
• Offer empathy before solutions
• Partner with them to problem-solve (when they're ready)
Remember: You can't reason with the emotional brain when it's in charge. Connection before correction, always.

3. **Validation isn't about giving in, it's about showing your child that their feelings are real and important.**
You can say things like, *"That was really upsetting,"* or *"I know this is hard for you."*
Once they feel heard, gently guide them by asking, "What can we do to help you feel better?" or *""Do you want a hug, or should we draw something together?"?"*

You are good enough.
Seriously, you are.
Good enough includes days where you lose it, days where you're too tired to engage, and days where you just survive.
It includes growth. Mess. Repair. And learning.
And through it all, your kids don't need a perfect parent.
They just need you.

(The author, Debika Chaudhuri, runs Elzix Foundation, an Educational Consultancy for the past twelve years. She has studied across three continents and has close to three decades of experience as an Executive Educator and Career Coach. She and her team help young people make important choices at critical junctures of their lives; develop self-confidence, if they don't know what to do; help develop their skills to make the right fit; create life-changing educational experiences and help them with college admissions. She may be reached at debikac@elzixfoundation.com)

"Just this one time"



Chaarvi Athawale

On a Saturday night at Powai Lake, a group of teenagers sits on the promenade, their sneakers swinging over the water. Their laughter sounds normal, until you notice the tiny plastic packets being passed around like candy. "It's just for the vibe," one of them shrugs when asked.



But the vibe has consequences. Their faces are too tired for their age, their pupils blown wide. This is the new reality: not just kids sneaking cigarettes behind a school wall, but an entire generation dancing on the edge of something far darker. And Powai is becoming the perfect stage for it.

The suburb that prides itself on its lakeside brunches, buzzing cafés, and glassy start-up offices just saw ₹45 crore worth of narcotics seized in a single nine-hour raid last month. The operation began at 10 a.m. and didn't stop until 7 p.m., spanning godowns, apartments, and transport routes, and ended with one chilling revelation: **Powai wasn't just a casual consumer. It was a key link in a ₹435 crore drug network stretching from Mysuru to Mumbai.**

That's not a headline. That's a warning shot. And if you think this was an isolated bust, think again. The drugs seized weren't just marijuana or hash, these were synthetic, lab-engineered substances like MDMA and mephedrone, designed to hijack brain chemistry, burn out dopamine receptors, and leave users hollowed out. These are not harmless college experiments. These are industrial-grade hooks.

The scary part? Powai is the perfect petri dish for this.

Think about it: you have moneyed residents in Hiranandani towers, transient students and tech workers in PGs and hostels, and a lively weekend scene that pulls in people from all over Mumbai. Add to that dealers who have now developed a deep network, delivering to you, handing out "starter packs", and offering oblivious teenagers chocolates laced with drugs. Put it all together and out comes a suburb where the supply never stops, and demand only grows.

And this isn't just a Powai problem. Across India, narcotics seizures have jumped 55% in the past year, with synthetic drugs leading the surge. Mumbai rehab centers already report that **one in three drug users is under 29.** The pattern is clear: the problem is young, fast-moving, and quietly burrowing into communities that think they're "too upscale" to be affected.

So, here's the uncomfortable question: Are we letting Powai sleepwalk into an epidemic?
Because this is how it always begins. First, it's a godown bust that makes the news cycle for a day. Then it's a few rehab cases that parents whisper about. And before anyone notices, it's an entire generation that has normalized pills on a Friday night, because "everyone's doing it."



So, what do we do?
Action doesn't mean waiting for the next headline-grabbing raid. It starts with shining a light on the local scene. Residents need more than whispers and rumours, they need neighborhood-level data that shows them the scale of the problem in black and white. When people know the numbers, they stop treating this as someone else's issue.

The conversation also needs to move into classrooms, college canteens, and housing society meetings. Not with fear tactics, but with facts. When young people are shown how synthetic drugs rewire the brain, how they affect memory and mental health, it stops being just another "cool" Friday-night experiment. Honest dialogue can do more than moral lectures ever will.

And we can't just talk; we have to build. Powai needs a safety net: peer-support programs, and accessible mental health counselling that can catch someone before they spiral. Prevention is always cheaper than recovery, and early intervention can save not just lives but years of potential.

Finally, there's the supply chain. Right now, enforcement is reactive, busts happen after the drugs are already here. That needs to change. Tightening controls on precursor chemicals, mapping distribution networks, and tracking repeat offenders can choke off the flow before it reaches the streets.

Powai can't afford to look away any longer. Every raid makes the news for a day, but behind every packet is a person, a life, a dream, a future being slowly burned away. The war is already here. The question is whether we're brave enough to fight it, together.

The festive buzz in Powai: A season of joy, unity and celebration



Powai, the vibrant suburb nestled around the serene Powai Lake, turns into a hub of cultural exuberance during the festive season. As soon as the monsoons retreat, the neighborhood gears up for an action-packed lineup of celebrations—Ganpati, Navratri, Diwali, Christmas, and New Year's Eve. These festivals aren't just moments of religious significance but occasions that bring people from diverse backgrounds together in shared joy and tradition. Let's dive into how each of these festivals adds its own unique buzz to Powai.

Ganpati Bappa Morya: The Elephant God Arrives in Splendor

Ganesh Chaturthi is perhaps the grandest celebration in Powai, setting the festive tone for the months to come. Societies across Hiranandani Gardens, Raheja Vihar, and Chandivali come alive with intricately designed Ganpati pandals. You'll often see local kids running stalls, selling everything from flower garlands to eco-friendly Ganpati idols made from clay to preserve Powai Lake.

Powai Lake becomes the focal point for the Ganesh Visarjan, with thousands of devotees thronging its shores for the immersion. The lakefront is usually decorated with lights and eco-friendly immersion platforms, contributing to a cleaner, greener celebration. The streets of Powai echo with chants of "Ganpati Bappa Morya!" as processions make their way to the lake, creating an atmosphere of devotion and camaraderie.

Navratri Nights: Garba, Dandiya, and Devotion

Once Ganpati bids adieu, Powai seamlessly transitions into the vibrant festival of Navratri. Hiranandani Gardens host some of the most popular Garba and Dandiya events. One of the most anticipated events is held at Hiranandani Heritage, where professional singers and live bands belt out traditional Garba songs alongside Bollywood tunes. Residents dress in colorful chaniya cholis, kurta-pajamas, and elaborate jewelry, transforming the streets and open grounds into a kaleidoscope of color and culture. The energy is infectious, and Powai's mixed community ensures that everyone, regardless of their cultural background, feels welcome to join the revelry.

Diwali: A Festival of Lights That Illuminates the Neighborhood

The buzz around Diwali in Powai is palpable weeks before the actual festival. Hiranandani Gardens transforms into a fairyland, with every tree and building strung with glowing lights. Residents go all out, decorating their balconies with lanterns and fairy lights, while rangolis adorn the entrance of every building and home. Popular spots like Galleria Mall and Haiko Supermarket offer Diwali discounts and gift hampers, drawing large crowds in the lead-up to the festival.

Firework displays are a major attraction, and societies often collaborate to host eco-friendly cracker events, ensuring that the spirit of Diwali shines brightly but responsibly.Community get-togethers are common during this time, with neighbors exchanging sweets, gifts, and well-wishes.

Christmas Cheer and New Year Revelry: A Global Festival with a Local Heart

As the year winds down, Christmas in Powai is celebrated with a unique blend of tradition and modern festivity. The cosmopolitan crowd of Powai ensures that this global festival feels intimate and close-knit. Holy Trinity Church in Powai conducts its midnight mass, where residents, regardless of their faith, gather to celebrate the birth of Christ. Carolers from local churches visit residential complexes, filling the air with hymns and festive cheer.

Restaurants and cafes in Haiko Mall and Galleria offer Christmas brunches, complete with plum cake, and mulled wine. Local bakeries roll out special Christmas-themed goodies, which quickly become neighborhood favorites.

Powai gears up for New Year's Eve with rooftop parties, gala dinners, and fireworks. Meluha The Fern and Rodas Ecotel hotels organize extravagant New Year's Eve celebrations, offering a perfect blend of luxury and revelry. The iconic Powai Lake Promenade becomes a peaceful spot for those looking for a quiet yet scenic place to reflect on the year past, offering breathtaking views of the fireworks lighting up the sky.

Powai's Festive Spirit: A Cultural Mosaic

What sets Powai apart is how seamlessly it embraces different cultures and festivals. From the booming dhols of Ganpati to the energetic dandiya beats of Navratri, the glittering diyas of Diwali, and the jingling bells of Christmas, Powai embodies a spirit of celebration that transcends boundaries. Whether you're soaking in the tradition or dancing into the New Year, the festive buzz in Powai makes sure there's something for everyone to enjoy.

In Powai, festivals aren't just about celebration—they're about community, culture, and the joy of coming together to create lasting memories

- Anushka Bahorey
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Back to the city of action - Mumbai



Girija Menon

After four months in the West, I'm back in Mumbai. And of course, I chose to return bang in the middle of the monsoons, when the city is at its most dramatic - wet, slippery, and damp to the core.

Now, don't get me wrong—I missed Mumbai. This is where I grew up, where my friends are, where I can drive (or attempt to, with one hand on the horn and the other on hope). It's where I'm most at ease. But love doesn't mean turning a blind eye. It means admitting—yes, you're beautiful, but you could use a whole lot of fixing up."

Because after a 19 -hour journey (flight plus layover in-between) , the city doesn't greet you with open arms. It slaps you awake. A city that never sleeps – most literally actually.

First stop, the airport. Before the nostalgia can even set in, you're fleeced by cab fares that seem to follow no known logic or economics—forget Uber surge pricing, this is Olympic-level surge. Step outside at midnight and you don't get calm, quiet darkness—you get chaos, traffic jams, and potholes so deep they could swallow an autorickshaw whole. Honestly, some of them deserve their own pin on Google Maps. Add Ganesh Visarjan to the mix, and it's a full-blown street party while you're wondering if you should just join the procession instead of fighting traffic.

This is where the contrast with my time abroad hits hardest. Over there, afternoons are so quiet you can hear yourself chew. Sitting in a gazebo in the company of the chirping birds, the swift squirrels and the alert hares. Children don't scream, dogs barely bark, and honking is treated like an insult to the driver. In Mumbai, silence is suspicious. If you don't hear a horn for five minutes, you check whether the city has been evacuated, much like lockdowns during covid, for Mumbai was indeed eerie.
Yet—here's the thing. As much as I roll my eyes at the lack of discipline on the roads and the infrastructure that feels like it's constantly two steps behind the population, I wouldn't trade this circus for silence. Because this is Amchi Mumbai.

Of course, returning to a locked-up house after months abroad has its own challenge. You open the door and the monsoon greets you with that musty, unmistakable smell—half mildew, half nostalgia. The kitchen is bare, so you're basically starting civilization all over again: scrubbing, stocking, and remembering that dal takes time to soak. And the dampness? It's so faithful it follows you into your clothes, your sheets, even your leftover biscuits. Parle-G becomes Parle-Sog.

It's not glamorous, but it's ritual. Half the year I live in quiet orderliness. The other half, I dive headfirst into glorious chaos.
Maybe that's the secret of Mumbai. It's exasperating, exhausting, and noisy. But it's also alive. It's messy, but it's not just mine but ours.

Threads that weave lives creating designs that depict your unique life. City you are born in, cities you work or study and yes cities that are far away where your loved ones reside. A life that needs this share of comfort and that share of love, affection, infant's cuddly giggles and above all when those tiny fingers hold on to yours – as if saying "please stay".

Bits of everything make life beautiful – with its perfection at times, with its flaws sometimes yet aligning perfectly to create a perfect picture.





(Girija Menon, the author, enjoys her passion for writing. Her first love is poetry; an astute observer of the world around us, she loves writing down her thoughts in both poems and prose. LIFE THREADS is what she uses to weave this one-of-a-kind fabric that spans reams. She can be reached at – whisperingverses@gmail.com)

Pṛthvī to Ākāśa: The Fivefold Foundation of all Creation (Part 3)
Agni; The Transformation Specialist



Palak Sardana

Fire element's role in the evolution of mankind is nothing short of a marvel. Once humans learnt its use & control, it set the ball rolling for man's personal progression and dominance. It empowered man to defend and protect itself & increased productivity by enabling it to see after dark. As fire's immense potential unfurled, its diverse applicability led to formation of communities (people would gather around it for warmth & company) on one hand & fuelled convenience & innovation (from pottery to metallurgy to industrial revolution) on the other.

A very interesting perspective on fire's role in making human brain sophisticated comes from Richard Wrangham, a professor of Biological Anthropology at Harvard. In his book 'Catching Fire: How Cooking made us Human', he hypothesises that because fire enabled cooking, eating cooked food didn't just prove more energy efficient but also facilitated easy bioavailability of nutrients. Fire's warmth also reduced body's calorie use for thermoregulation. This freed up energy for brain growth & development and enabled better cognitive performance for humans to think, reflect, evolve and innovate.

Ayurveda too endorses efficient digestibility of cooked food. It emphasises that cooking increases the 'fire element' in the food, making it easier to breakdown. However, Ayurveda's exploration of the fire element (agni) runs deeper as it recognises it's all-pervading nature in both the manifested as well as the unmanifested (its source itself).

Agni is considered the central principle of life as all the 'doing' (activity, awareness, transformation, conversion) is governed by it. If it dwindles, the life-force weakens, paving way for weakness, disease and eventually death.

Ayurveda identifies its play in the forms of Jatharagni (digestive fire in stomach and duodenum), Bhutagni (elemental fire that metabolises five elements from food to tissues), Dhatvagni (fire present in the saptadhatus/seven tissues) & Tejas (the subtle fire associated with higher intelligence, vitality & subtle energy).

Jatharagni is the torch bearer of all agnis' as it converts food into fuel which in turn empowers the function of every other system of mind and body. Bhagwad Gita too emphasises its significance where Krishna when explaining the essence of all that is most refined and superior manifestation of Brahman, equates Jatharagni (amongst all agnis') to be its most efficient manifestation.



Fire signifies motivation; a will to do something. When this element diminishes, a person loses all enthusiasm and lethargy & depression sets in. Dedicated practices like surya namaskar, surya- bhedi pranayama & agnisara are prescribed in the yogic tradition to improve the state of fire-element. Certain foods (mostly pungent spices) are used medicinally in Ayurveda to ignite the digestive fire. Ginger combined with some lemon & a pinch of salt when chewed before meals & consumption of Ayurvedic formulations' like trikatu improves the digestive fire tremendously.

Its imperative to note that fire's only useful if it is controlled and regulated. Just the way an untamed fire can become all consuming, so is the case when it intensifies with in the human system. A strong digestive fire (in pitta dominant people) must be fed timely else it feeds on bodily tissues itself. An aggravated pitta can lead to many physiological and psychological disorders right from ulcers, hyper acidity, high bp to anger, greed, lust and unsatiable ambition. A pitta pacifying diet focused on sweet, bitter and astringents flavours along with restorative yoga practices is helpful.

Fire is considered the purest element as it cannot be polluted. It is in fact a purifier. The very first hymn of Rgveda is dedicated to Lord Agni (the fire God) who is the carrier of all offerings and messages to the divine and a bestower of wealth and well-being in return. Vedas also refer to Agni as Rtāvān — the one aligned with Ṛta (the cosmic order) for it upholds Ṛta by being a messenger between realms, the light of truth, the transformer of offerings and actions, the inner purifier and the witness of deeds. In its absence, the cycle of yajña, truth, and transformation — the very fabric of Ṛta — would collapse.

The ritual of yajna is largely understood to be a fire ceremony where intention is held and offerings are made into fire to gain the desired outcome. But at the spiritual level, yajña is a selfless activity which is undertaken to maintain Rta (the natural order).

We humans are selfish as fear dictates our lives. Hence it takes a great deal of purposeful effort called tapas (comes from the word 'taap' which means heat) to know one's true self and act selflessly for greater good.

We have utilised fire optimally to progress physically, mentally & materially. But are we intelligent enough to unleash its full potential & evolve spiritually? Now that would be a transformation worthy of awe!

(Palak Sardana is a Harvard certified wellness coach, a mental health counsellor, yoga teacher & founder of wellness venture, Tranquility Unlimited. Via these articles, her endeavour is to present non-invasive & practical models of wellness grounded in ancient wisdom and modern scientific research. She runs ongoing wellness classes. For joining or booking a personalized consultation/session, write to tranquilityunlimited@gmail.com)

Reset your body post festivities



Nisha Singh

Festivals are the heart of India. Each one brings with it the joy of family get-togethers, friends having fun and of course loads of food. Be it Navratri, Diwali, Christmas or Eid, every celebration is incomplete without an array of food ranging from rich savouries to delicious desserts. Not only do most festivals bring heavy, calorie laden foods but they often also include late nights, alcohol and irregular water intake. While one enjoys and creates a ton of happy memories, celebrations if not done with balance leave a negative after effect on the body - fatigue, disturbed sleep, dehydration, bloating, indigestion are the most common complaints I hear from my patients.

Most often people resort to very harsh regimes post festivities in order to reset their bodies. Nothing could be more damaging to the body than this. Post festival is the time to be gentle on the body. Opt for gentler and slower, simple changes so that the body can truly "Detox" and restore its balance.

- **Hydrate -** Overindulgence in rich foods and sweets, late nights and consuming alcohol often leaves the body dehydrated. In fact this is such a vicious cycle for most people that consuming rich food often leads them to experience sugar cravings. When the fact is that it actually is dehydration, the body is asking for water to flush out the toxins and restore the electrolyte balance. Hence, ensure that post celebrations you consciously drink more water. 8-10 glasses of water a day should be the aim. You can also include herb teas like tulsi and ginger steeped tea, mint and lemon, fennel seeds and mint tea and so on. Alternatively you could add infused water to your daily routine for a few days. Include at least a glass of coconut water for a minimum of one week. Upping your hydration game will not only ensure detoxification of toxins from the system but also help to restore electrolyte balance, reduce fatigue, improve skin as well as digestion.



- **Nourishing Meals -** It's now time to include light and wholesome meals in the diet. Most people tend to either go on fasts or extreme diets. This is their understanding of trying to get rid of the excess calories as well as the guilt of indulgence. This is an erroneous approach. Fasting is not for everyone. And fasts are also of several types. One must select the method which is suitable for your body and routine. The best approach is to include light and nourishing meals like dal - rice, khichdi, vegetable soups, steamed or sauteed vegetables. Aim to reduce fat and sugar intake not eliminate it completely. Balanced meals not only help stabilise the sugar but also help to reduce inflammation in the body. Also, focus on including nutrients such as Vitamin C rich foods like lemon, guava, amla, mint, kiwi, pomegranate etc, and spices like cinnamon, cardamom and fennel in the diet to help detoxify the body as well as strengthen it.



- **Gut health -** Gut is what takes the major hit during indulgences, Bloating, indigestion, hyperacidity and even constipation are the most common complaints. It therefore becomes very important to focus on improving gut health during such times. Include digestive spices like ajwain, asafoetida, cumin seeds, fennel seeds in the diet. Tea made with these spices can also be consumed. Another option is to make a churna or powder out of these and take a teaspoon of it with warm water post meals. Along with this try to include good sources of pre and probiotics in the meals like curd, buttermilk, kimchi, fermented foods, garlic, banana, oats etc. Also slowly include a variety of millets like ragi, jowar, barley etc. in the diet. Millets are a good source of fiber and will help in easing bowel movements.



- **Movement -** Include gentle exercises. Do not rush into hectic or harsh workout routines in order to compensate for all the excess calories. All the celebrations Your body will thank you if you go gentler on it. Opting for a high intensity workout immediately post any indulgence further stresses the body. The body finds it hard to come to a state of balance and as a result the inflammation increases. Restart your exercise routines with short periods of walks. Include yoga and pranayama to get back in the rhythm. In a week to ten days, you should be ready to resume your regular workouts.



- **Sleep -** All the late night parties increase the sleep debt that almost all of us face. Erratic timings kick the body's natural clock called the circadian rhythm out of whack. This leads to disturbances not only in sleep cycles, but also causes fluctuations in hormone and weight. Practice sleep hygiene - screens off an hour before bed, cool environment, dim lights. Include either a cup of warm haldi milk at bedtime or a cup of chamomile tea. One helps aid sleep while the other calms the mind. Practice slow, deep breaths before bed. This not only helps in sleep but also lowers inflammation.



A few days of consistent mindful eating, and lifestyle practices will help reset and restore your body. It will help bring back the energy and vitality. So, this season, once the glimmer of lights and the sweet boxes are put away, bring balance back to your life.

Wishing everyone a Glorious Diwali!!

You can follow Dietitian Nisha on Instagram for nutrition & fitness tips and live interactive sessions at – nurtiwellness.by.dt.nishas

We at My Powai are taking our readers' queries related to Diet & Nutrition, which Ms. Nisha Singh will reply to in our forthcoming issues.

You can send your questions at: dietnutrition.queries@gmail.com

(The writer is a gold medalist in Food & Nutrition with more than 12 years experience. She manages various ailments through lifestyle and dietary modifications and specializes in weight loss & management. She practices at 102, Crystal Center, Raheja Vihar, Powai or Smile Craft, 23, Annapurna Industrial estate, Opp. CCD, Ghatkopar East. For appointments: 022 2857 6537 Email: singhnisha@gmail.com)

Flavors of faith - Part 2



Sherry Bhatnagar

In the bustling coastal town of Puri, where the rhythmic waves of the Bay of Bengal kiss the sands of faith, lies a kitchen unlike any other in the world.

In Puri's Jagannath Temple, food becomes divinity. Cooked in earthen pots over wood-fired chulhas, the Mahaprasad is a sacred offering where every grain is blessed. From the fragrant Kanika to the soulful Dalma and hearty Mahura, these satvik dishes, prepared without onion or garlic, carry centuries of tradition.

Served in the temple's Ananda Bazaar, Mahaprasad is more than a meal — it is a symbol of equality, where devotees from all walks of life sit together, sharing food that nourishes both body and spirit.

Kanika- (Temple-Style Sweet Pulao)



- Kanika is one of the most loved Jagannath Temple Mahaprasad dishes — a sweet, fragrant pulao made with rice, ghee, sugar, and dry fruits which is very easy to make.

Ingredients (for 4 servings)

- Basmati / Gobindobhog rice – 1 cup (washed & soaked 30 mins)
- Ghee – 3 to 4 tbsp
- Sugar – ½ to ¾ cup (adjust sweetness to taste)
- Cashew nuts – 2 tbsp
- Raisins – 2 tbsp
- Cardamom powder – ½ tsp
- Bay leaf – 1
- Cloves – 3–4
- Cinnamon – 1 small stick
- Water – about 2 cups (for cooking rice)
- Salt – a pinch (balances the sweetness)

Method of Preparation
For Khaja

- Wash & soak rice for 30 minutes. Drain well.
- In a heavy-bottom pan/kadai, heat ghee. Fry cashews & raisins until golden. Remove and keep aside. In the same ghee, add bay leaf, cloves, and cinnamon. Sauté until aromatic. Add the drained rice and gently sauté in ghee for 2–3 minutes (this gives a rich flavour). Add measured water + pinch of salt, cover, and cook until the rice is 90% done.
- Add sugar and mix gently (the rice will release some liquid). Cook on very low flame until rice grains are soft and sugar is absorbed. Sprinkle cardamom powder, fried cashews, and raisins. Mix carefully without breaking rice.
- Let it rest for 5 minutes, then serve warm.

Please note that the taste of the dish is slightly sweet, fragrant, and rich from ghee. The texture is not mushy — rice grains remain separate. This dish is often served with Dalma or as part of a Mahaprasad thali.

Mahura (Mixed Vegetable Curry)



Mahura is another signature dish. It's a mildly spiced mixed vegetable curry prepared without onion or garlic, using seasonal vegetables and a curd–spice base. Traditionally, it's cooked in earthen pots on wood fire.

Ingredients (for 4–5 servings)

- Pumpkin (kaddu) – 150 g
- Raw banana – 1 medium
- Yam (suran/jimikand) – 100 g (optional, can replace with potato)
- Sweet potato – 1 medium
- Drumstick – 1–2 pieces
- Brinjal – 1 small
- Potato – 1 medium
- Green beans – 6–8
- Carrot – 1 small
- Curd – ½ cup (whisked)
- Grated coconut – 2 tbsp
- Mustard seeds (for paste) – 1 tsp
- Cumin seeds – 1 tsp
- Dry red chilli – 2
- Ginger – 1 inch piece
- Bay leaf – 1
- Panch phoron (mix of fennel, fenugreek, cumin, mustard, kalonji) – ½ tsp
- Turmeric powder – ½ tsp
- Red chilli powder – ½ tsp (optional, very light)
- Salt – to taste
- Ghee – 2 tbs

Method of Preparation

- Prep vegetables: Peel and chop all vegetables into medium cubes.
- Make masala paste: Grind mustard seeds, cumin, dry red chilli, ginger, and coconut with little water into a fine paste.
- Cook vegetables: In a large pan, heat ghee. Add bay leaf and panch phoron. Add all chopped vegetables, turmeric, and salt. Sauté for 3–4 mins.
- Add the masala paste, stir well, and cook for 5–6 mins until raw smell goes. Add just enough water to cook the vegetables. Cover and simmer until they are soft but not mushy.
- Once cooked, lower flame and add whisked curd. Stir gently (avoid curdling).
- Finish with a drizzle of ghee.

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(Sherry Bhatnagar is the founder of Anubhuti Food Ventures — a passionate food visionary, avid traveller and wellness advocate. With a deep-rooted belief that food is one of the purest expressions of care, she champions traditional Indian flavours, forgotten recipes, and nourishing meals. Through her writing, she invites readers to rediscover the emotional and cultural richness of home-cooked food, and the timeless wisdom that simmers in every regional dish.)

October 2025



Richa Pathak

Aries (Mar 21 - Apr 19) October inspires action and bold decisions, but don't rush—patience will keep you on the right path. Guidance from a mentor or elder could bring clarity in career matters. As Diwali approaches, your energy feels renewed, helping you shed what's old and step into a more confident version of yourself. **Lucky Color:** Scarlet Red **Lucky Day:** Tuesday **Remedy:** On Diwali morning, mix a pinch of rock salt in your bath-water to release negativity and refresh your spirit.

Taurus (Apr 20 - May 20)
This month highlights relationships and financial stability. Take time to evaluate where you invest your trust and resources. Around Diwali, peace and warmth at home will uplift you, making it a perfect time to strengthen family bonds. **Lucky Color:** Earthy Brown **Lucky Day:** Thursday **Remedy:** Keep a coin near the Diwali diyas and later place it in your wallet to draw steady prosperity.

Gemini (May 21 - Jun 20)
Your words carry extra weight this month—be mindful of how you communicate. Open and honest discussions can heal relationships, while careless remarks could cause rifts. During Diwali, new connections or creative ideas may brighten your path. **Lucky Color:** Electric Blue **Lucky Day:** Wednesday **Remedy:** On Diwali night, write your intentions for the coming year and tuck them away safely until the next festival.

Cancer (Jun 21 - Jul 22)
October calls for emotional balance and thoughtful choices. Opportunities may arise that test your reactions, but staying grounded will bring rewards. Diwali celebrations will deepen your connection with loved ones and offer emotional healing. **Lucky Color:** Silver **Lucky Day:** Monday **Remedy:** Place a silver item in moonlight during Diwali week to absorb positive lunar energy.

Leo (Jul 23 - Aug 22)
Ambitions and creativity shine this month, but focus is needed to turn ideas into reality. In love, compromise will strengthen bonds. Diwali amplifies your charm, helping you attract recognition and support from others. **Lucky Color:** Gold **Lucky Day:** Sunday **Remedy:** Add saffron strands to a bowl of water during Diwali puja and sprinkle it in your workspace for success and fame.

Virgo (Aug 23 - Sep 22)
October urges you to simplify routines and care for your inner self. Even small adjustments to your daily habits will make a big difference. Around Diwali, clearing your space brings peace of mind and fresh energy. **Lucky Color:** Olive Green **Lucky Day:** Friday **Remedy:** Light sandalwood incense on Diwali morning to cleanse your surroundings and promote clarity.



Libra (Sep 23 - Oct 22)
Teamwork and partnerships take center stage this month. Success comes from collaboration and diplomacy. Diwali brings harmony into your personal and professional life, making it a wonderful time to celebrate togetherness. **Lucky Color:** Lavender **Lucky Day:** Thursday **Remedy:** Burn a lavender-scented candle during Diwali to invite balance and cooperative energy.

Scorpio (Oct 23 - Nov 21)
This month encourages you to influence others subtly rather than trying to control situations. Career changes may feel unsettling at first but will lead to hidden opportunities. Diwali will help you release what no longer serves you. **Lucky Color:** Deep Red **Lucky Day:** Monday **Remedy:** Keep rose quartz near your Diwali diya to radiate loving and healing energy.

Sagittarius (Nov 22 - Dec 21)
Adventure, travel, and learning remain key themes this month. While new experiences excite you, ensure they align with your bigger goals. Diwali inspires you to broaden your horizons with wisdom and optimism. **Lucky Color:** Bright Yellow **Lucky Day:** Friday **Remedy:** Hold a sunstone in your hand during Diwali rituals to boost clarity and enthusiasm.

Capricorn (Dec 22 - Jan 19)
October asks you to focus on building steady foundations for the future. Financial and emotional matters may require careful planning. Diwali's energy offers a chance to cleanse old karmic patterns and start afresh. **Lucky Color:** Charcoal Grey **Lucky Day:** Saturday **Remedy:** Offer rice grains into flowing water on Diwali to release past blockages.

Aquarius (Jan 20 - Feb 18)
Contracts and commitments become significant now. Pause before making big decisions and weigh all sides carefully. Relationships may shift, calling for balance and compromise. Diwali's light helps you see the path ahead more clearly. **Lucky Color:** Sky Blue **Lucky Day:** Wednesday **Remedy:** Place an amethyst crystal near your Diwali diya to sharpen intuition.

Pisces (Feb 19 - Mar 20)
Your intuition is heightened this month, guiding you toward spiritual and personal growth. Pay attention to subtle signs—they will lead to profound insights. Diwali offers you a chance to align with divine energy and find inner peace. **Lucky Color:** Aqua **Lucky Day:** Sunday **Remedy:** Offer fresh flowers to a river, lake, or pond during Diwali week as a gesture of devotion and flow with life.

(Astrologer Richa Pathak masters the art of Astrology, Vastu & Numerology. In-person consultation with prior appointment can be done at 207, Lantana, Nahar Amrit Shakti, Chandivali, Powai. She also gives Virtual Consultation & can be reached @ 8452920640 & www.jyotishdham.com)